



US00PP29078P2

(12) **United States Plant Patent**
Holtmaat

(10) **Patent No.:** **US PP29,078 P2**
(45) **Date of Patent:** **Mar. 6, 2018**

(54) **MONARDA PLANT NAMED ‘MON0004BLI’**

(50) Latin Name: *Monarda didyma*
Varietal Denomination: **MON0004BLI**

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(*) Notice: Subject to any disclaimer, the term of this
patent is extended or adjusted under 35
U.S.C. 154(b) by 0 days.

(21) Appl. No.: **15/330,934**

(22) Filed: **Nov. 15, 2016**

(51) **Int. Cl.**
A01H 5/02 (2006.01)

(52) **U.S. Cl.**
USPC **Plt./455**

(58) **Field of Classification Search**

USPC Plt./455
See application file for complete search history.

(56) **References Cited**

PUBLICATIONS

UPOV hit on *Monarda* plant named ‘MON0004BLI’, QZ PBR
20162315, filed Sep. 23, 2016.*

* cited by examiner

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(57) **ABSTRACT**

A new and distinct cultivar of *Monarda* plant named
‘MON0004BLI’, characterized by its broadly upright plant
habit; dark green-colored leaves; freely flowering habit;
large inflorescences with light red purple-colored flowers;
long flowering period; and tolerance to Powdery Mildew.

2 Drawing Sheets

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Botanical designation: *Monarda didyma*.
Cultivar denomination: ‘MON0004BLI’.

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

The present invention relates to a new and distinct cultivar
of *Monarda* plant, botanically known as *Monarda didyma*,
typically grown a container plant and hereinafter referred to
by the name ‘MON0004BLI’.

The new *Monarda* plant is a product of a planned breed-
ing program conducted by the Inventor in Zuidwolde, The
Netherlands. The objective of the breeding program is to
create new *Monarda* plants with attractive flowers and
tolerance to Powdery Mildew.

The new *Monarda* plant originated from an open-pollina-
tion during the summer of 2013 of an unnamed selection
of *Monarda didyma*, not patented, as the female, or seed,
parent with an unknown selection of *Monarda didyma*, as
the male, or pollen, parent. The new *Monarda* plant was
discovered and selected by the Inventor as a single flowering
plant from within the progeny of the stated open-pollination
grown in a controlled nursery environment in Zuidwolde,
The Netherlands during the summer of 2014.

Asexual reproduction of the new *Monarda* plant by cut-
tings in Zuidwolde, The Netherlands, since June, 2016 has
shown that the unique features of this new *Monarda* plant
are stable and reproduced true to type in successive genera-
tions.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

Plants of the new *Monarda* have not been observed under
all possible combinations of environmental conditions and
cultural practices. The phenotype may vary somewhat with

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variations in environmental conditions such as temperature
and light intensity without, however, any variance in geno-
type.

The following traits have been repeatedly observed and
are determined to be the unique characteristics of
‘MON0004BLI’. These characteristics in combination dis-
tinguish ‘MON0004BLI’ as a new and distinct *Monarda*
plant:

1. Broadly upright plant habit.
2. Dark green-colored leaves.
3. Freely flowering habit.
4. Large inflorescences with light red purple-colored
flowers.
5. Long flowering period.
6. Tolerant to Powdery Mildew.

Plants of the new *Monarda* differ primarily from plants of
the female parent selection in plant uniformity as plants of
the new *Monarda* are more uniform than plants of the female
parent selection.

Plants of the new *Monarda* can be compared to plants of
Monarda didyma ‘Fishes’, not patented. In side-by-side
comparisons, plants of the new *Monarda* differ from plants
of ‘Fishes’ in the following characteristics:

1. Plants of the new *Monarda* are more freely flowering
and have larger flowers than plants of ‘Fishes’.
2. Plants of the new *Monarda* flower for a longer period
of time than plants of ‘Fishes’.
3. Flowers of plants of the new *Monarda* are not persistent
whereas flowers of plants of ‘Fishes’ are persistent.
4. Plants of the new *Monarda* are more tolerant to
Powdery Mildew than plants of ‘Fishes’.

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE PHOTOGRAPHS

The accompanying colored photographs illustrate the
overall appearance of the new *Monarda* plant showing the

colors as true as it is reasonably possible to obtain in colored reproductions of this type. Colors in the photographs may differ slightly from the color values cited in the detailed botanical description which accurately describe the actual colors of the new *Monarda* plant.

The photograph on the first sheet is a side perspective view of a typical flowering plant of 'MON0004BLI' grown in a container.

The photograph at the top of the second sheet is a close-up view of the upper surface of typical leaves of 'MON0004BLI'.

The photograph at the bottom of the second sheet is a close-up view of a typical inflorescence of 'MON0004BLI'.

DETAILED BOTANICAL DESCRIPTION

The aforementioned photographs and following observations, measurements and values describe plants grown during the late spring in 21-cm containers in a polyethylene-covered structure in Zuidwolde, The Netherlands and under cultural practices typical of commercial *Monarda* production. During the production of the plants, day temperatures ranged from 12° C. to 25° C. and night temperatures ranged from 4° C. to 15° C. Plants were two years old when the photographs and the description were taken. In the detailed description, color references are made to The Royal Horticultural Society Colour Chart, 2007 Edition, except where general terms of ordinary dictionary significance are used. Botanical classification: *Monarda didyma* 'MON0004BLI'. Parentage:

Female, or seed, parent.—Unnamed selection of *Monarda didyma*, not patented.

Male, or pollen, parent.—Unknown selection of *Monarda didyma*, not patented.

Propagation:

Type cutting.—By cuttings.

Time to initiate roots, summer.—About two weeks at temperatures about 20° C.

Time to produce a rooted young plant, summer.—About two months at temperatures about 20° C.

Root description.—Medium in thickness, fibrous; typically creamy white in color, actual color of the roots is dependent on substrate composition, water quality, fertilizer type and formulation, substrate temperature and physiological age of roots.

Rooting habit.—Moderately freely branching; medium density.

Plant description:

Plant and growth habit.—Herbaceous perennial; broadly upright plant form; overall plant form, obovate; moderately vigorous to vigorous growth habit.

Plant height.—About 63.1 cm.

Plant width.—About 67.3 cm.

Lateral branch description.—Branching habit: Freely basal branching habit with about six main stems, each main stem with about ten lateral branches. Length: About 14.6 cm. Diameter: About 3.5 mm. Internode length: About 5.3 cm. Strength: Strong. Aspect: Mostly upright. Texture and luster: Moderately to densely pubescent; slightly glossy. Color: Close to 144A.

Leaf description:

Arrangement.—Opposite, simple.

Length.—About 13.3 cm.

Width.—About 8.5 cm.

Shape.—Ovate.

Apex.—Apiculate, twisted.

Base.—Truncate to slightly cordate.

Margin.—Serrate.

Texture and luster, upper surface.—Moderately pubescent and moderately rugose; slightly glossy.

Texture and luster, lower surface.—Densely pubescent; slightly glossy.

Venation pattern.—Pinnate.

Fragrance.—Moderately fragrant; pleasant, spicy.

Color.—Developing leaves, upper surface: Close to between 144A and 144B. Developing leaves, lower surface: Close to 144B. Fully expanded leaves, upper surface: Darker than between 147A and N189A; venation, close to 146D. Fully expanded leaves, lower surface: Close to 137A; venation, close to 146C to 146D.

Petioles.—Length: About 1.8 cm. Diameter: About 3 mm by 4.5 mm. Color, upper and lower surfaces: Close to 144A; proximally on the upper surface, tinged with close to 147A.

Flower description:

Flower form, arrangement and flowering habit.—Single labiate flowers arranged in large terminal globular spikes; flowers face outwardly; freely flowering habit with about 160 flowers developing per inflorescence and about 2,500 flowers developing per plant during the flowering season.

Natural flowering season.—Long flowering habit, plants flower from mid-July to mid-September in The Netherlands.

Postproduction longevity.—Flowers maintain good substance for about five days on the plant; flowers not persistent.

Fragrance.—Faintly fragrant; pleasant, spicy.

Flower buds.—Length: About 2.1 cm. Diameter: About 3 mm. Shape: Narrowly oblanceolate; curved. Color: Close to 68C and 68D; distally, stripes, close to 61B; immature calyx, close to 150D, 174B and 200B.

Inflorescence height.—About 6 cm.

Inflorescence diameter.—About 8 cm.

Flower length (vertical).—About 2 cm.

Flower diameter (horizontal).—About 6 mm.

Flower depth (height).—About 4.1 cm.

Petals.—Arrangement: Labiate; upper lip hooded; lower lip, a single lobe; lips fused 60% of total length. Length, upper and lower lips: About 3.9 cm. Width, upper lip: About 3 mm. Width, lower lip: About 8 mm. Shape, upper lip: Lanceolate; apex, acute. Shape, lower lip: Oblanceolate; apex, caudate. Margin, upper and lower lips: Entire; lower petal, slightly undulate and slightly twisted. Texture and luster, upper and lower lips, upper surface: Smooth, glabrous; matte. Texture and luster, upper and lower lips, lower surface: Moderately pubescent; matte. Color, upper lip: When opening, upper and lower surfaces: Close to 68C. Fully opened, upper and lower surfaces: Close to 73B; color does not change with development. Color, lower lip: When opening, upper and lower surfaces: Close to 68B. Fully opened, upper and lower surfaces: Close to 73B to 73C; color does not change with development.

Sepals.—Quantity and arrangement: Five in a single whorl; lower 90% fused into a tubular calyx. Length: About 9 mm. Width: About 0.5 mm. Apex: Narrowly

acute. Margin: Free parts, finely serrate. Texture and luster, upper and lower surfaces: Pubescent; dull. Color: When opening, upper and lower surfaces: Proximally, close to 150D; distally, close to 174B; free parts, close to 200B. Fully opened, upper and lower surfaces: Proximally, close to 150D; distally, close to 174B; free parts, close to 200B.

Pedicels.—Length: About 1 mm. Diameter: About 0.5 mm. Strength: Moderately strong. Color: Close to 150D.

Inflorescence bracts.—Quantity and arrangement: About 26 at the base of inflorescence. Length: About 1.7 cm. Width: About 1.3 cm. Shape: Ovate to narrowly ovate; apex, acute. Margin: Entire. Texture, upper surface: Glabrous; velvety. Texture, lower surface: Pubescent. Color: When opening and fully opened, upper surface: Close to 186C; proximally, close to 137D. When opening and fully opened, lower surface: Close to N137A to N137C.

Reproductive organs.—Stamens: Quantity per flower: Two. Filament length: About 1.6 cm. Filament color: Close to between 67D to 68C. Anther length: About 2 mm. Anther shape: Narrowly elliptic. Anther color:

Close to 67C. Pollen amount: Moderate. Pollen color: Close to 11C. Pistils: Quantity per flower: One. Pistil length: About 3.6 cm. Stigma shape: Cleft, unequal. Stigma color: Close to 77C. Style length: About 3.75 cm. Style color: Close to 72B; towards the base, close to NN155C to NN155D. Ovary color: Close to 150D.

Seed and fruit.—Seed and fruit production have not been observed on plants of the new *Monarda*.

10 Pathogen & pest resistance: Plants of the new *Monarda* have been observed to be tolerant to Powdery Mildew (*Erysiphe cichoracearum*). Plants of the new *Monarda* not been observed to be resistant to pests and other pathogens common to *Monarda* plants.

15 Garden performance: Plants of the new *Monarda* have exhibited good tolerance to rain, wind and high temperatures about 30° C. and to be hardy to USDA Hardiness Zone 5.

It is claimed:

1. A new and distinct *Monarda* plant named 'MON0004BLI' as illustrated and described.

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